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Technology Drives Us

Visual Studio Team Services (formerly known as Visual Studio Online) and Visual Studio Code.

The global tech giant will also be using Marketplace to sell a new kind of Visual Studio subscription. Visual Studio Professional and Enterprise are together obtainable through MSDN subscriptions bought on an annual basis. These subscriptions also provide development access to many other pieces of Microsoft software.

The company is now offering Visual Studio Professional and Enterprise as cloud subscriptions, with the option of buying these either each month or annually.

The company will unveil a new Visual Studio bundle called Dev Essentials, to make all-device development easier to access like Visual Studio Community Edition, the free tier of Visual Studio Team Services, and from early next year, monthly Azure credits. It will supposedly comprise everything needed to develop for Windows, Android and iOS.



However, building for iOS still requires access to a Mac; Visual Studio remotely controls the OS X toolchain to perform the actual building and application deployment. Microsoft has partnered with MacinCloud to provide access to OS X build agents for US\$ 30/month for those who don't want to manage Macs on their own.

In addition to using the built-in support for Android and iOS development, Visual Studio is often used in combination with the Xamarin platform for cross-platform applications. The release of Xamarin 4 comes with a new crash and performance analytics tool, Xamarin Insights, and version 2 of its Xamarin Forms library. It adds new iOS 9 and Android Marshmallow controls, and a new build agent for performing software builds on OS X from inside Visual Studio that should be easier to set up and more reliable than the current mechanism.

As well as the GDB debugging extension, Azure Service Fabric—the management infrastructure for microservices on Azure that is used by Microsoft for Cortana, Lync, and Azure SQL, is now accessible for public preview.

Canonical releases OpenStack Autopilot

Canonical has released OpenStack Autopilot, a cloud management tool for Ubuntu Linux in a bid to bring OpenStack private clouds to the masses. This is Canonical's latest move in the open source cloud computing market.

Till last year, Autopilot was available in beta form, but it is now generally available and is a feature in Landscape, Canonical's platform for managing deployments of Ubuntu systems.

It extends the product to include support for automated OpenStack deployment and administration using Ubuntu servers. It can set up clouds, add new hardware to existing clouds and assist with cloud management.

Autopilot also offers the ability to run OpenStack administrative services inside dedicated containers via LXD, Canonical's home-grown virtualisation hypervisor.

According to Canonical, it supports a range of software-defined storage and networking options which now include OpenDaylight, an open source SDN that is new to Autopilot, debuting with the general-availability release.

The company is offering Autopilot for entities to build private clouds using OpenStack, without having to spend money on hiring OpenStack knowhow.